



HTML5 versus Flash

YouTube is one of the biggest examples of the success of RIA technologies. It is increasingly delivering full length movies and live streaming events, and doing this without any issues or interruptions often requires fine control over buffering and dynamic quality control. Kuan Yong, ex-platforms product manager at Google's

YouTube, says that despite his company's efforts to make YouTube videos run in an HTML5 player, Flash isn't going anywhere. "Flash Player addresses these needs by letting applications manage the downloading and playback of video via ActionScript in conjunction with either HTTP or the RTMP video streaming protocol," explains Yong. "The HTML5 standard itself does not address video streaming protocols, but a number of vendors and organisations are working to improve the experience of delivering video over [HTTP](#)." YouTube also has to offer copy protection for some videos, like YouTube Rentals. The Flash Platform's RTMPE protocol is compatible with copyright protection technology, but HTML5 is not. Flash also remains the preferred option for video embedding. In conjunction with Google's decision to bake Flash support into its Android devices, Flash doesn't appear to be going anywhere anytime soon.

Nonetheless the iPhone and iPad put Flash and any plug-in based RIA application in general in a bad spotlight. Apple's side of the story is that Flash is a low performance, insecure, battery life drainer. Steve Jobs has been quoted in some articles as saying that Adobe programmers were "lazy" because they didn't improve Flash. But despite its popularity this is not an issue only restricted to Flash but all plug-in based RIA frameworks. Microsoft Silverlight and Java are also affected by many of the issues affecting Flash. None of these run on the iPhone or



iPad today. HTML5 though is hailed as the future of the Web and RIA development. But it could take a very long time for it to be mature enough for extensive use. HTML5 is large and complex, and if we are to trust current projections, all parts would only be complete by the year 2022, some 18 years after the process started in 2004.